

ME TAB X1 FROM HCL: A FEATURE- LOADED, AFFORDABLE TABLET

The year 2011 redefined the tablet market completely. Tablets as a genre caught the attention of the consumers, not only because users found a place for them between the smartphone and the laptops, in the gadget eco-system. But the biggest reason was the fact that the tablets didn't exclusively remain the device for the rich. A whole bunch of tablets were launched in the sub ₹20,000 price bracket.

The budget tablets tend to offer the full tablet experience, but do compromise on certain aspects. These will usually be features/specs or performance. This is largely due to the fact that in comparison to the more expensive siblings, the budget tablets have a slightly less powerful processor, display with less resolution, a slightly older version of Android and sometimes even less memory. Critically, the price has to be kept low, so as to allow a bigger consumer demographic the ability to afford this unique device and integrate it into their lives.

Let's take a look at the critical aspects of a tablet individually, and see where the rivals stand in comparison to each other.

PROCESSOR

An ARM Cortex A8 processor that clocks at 1GHz powers the ME Tab X1 from HCL. The range of processors we see in this price bracket usually range between 800MHz and 1GHz. The ARM Cortex A8 processors clocking at 1GHz power all the Mercury MTab, the Viewsonic ViewPad 7e and the iBall Slide. The only 800MHz tablet in this price segment is the Reliance 3G Tab, which is powered by an ARM 11 processor. No shortage of power on these tablets, despite being much lower priced than the higher end tablets.



The only sacrifice, at least in this aspect, is the CPU core specification. All the above-mentioned processors are single core ones, unlike the dual core versions that power the higher priced versions.

DISPLAY

We often hear that tablets are available between 7-inch and 10-inch display sizes. However, the 7-inch display size is the most popular one in this price category. Except the MSI Enjoy 10, all the rivals have similar display sizes. The Mercury MTab, Beetel Magiq, Reliance 3G Tab and the iBall Slide have a display resolution of 480x800 pixels, while the Viewsonic ViewPad 7e has a resolution of 800x600 pixels. The ME Tab X1 from HCL also has a display resolution of 480x800 pixels on the 7-inch display.

A higher resolution might sound better on a display, but what is more important is the crispness of the display, no matter what the pixel specs.